SPEAKER NOTES · CONFIDENTIAL

UniverCell Holding GmbH Speaker notes

Sixteen slides, about twenty-five minutes with questions. Each page carries the slide, the line to open with, the beats in order, and the question most likely to come back at you.

HOW TO USE THIS

- **Do not read the slides.** The slides carry the numbers so you can carry the argument. Every beat below is a thing to say, not a thing to display.
- **The three slides that matter are 2, 9 and 15.** Slide 2 is the whole answer, slide 9 is the analysis nobody else has done, slide 15 is what to do about it. If you lose time, cut from the early industry slides, never from these.
- **Volunteer the weaknesses before he finds them.** The certification gap, the missing customer names, the 2.4% energy deficit against Molicel. Saying them first is what makes everything else credible.
- **Ranges, not point estimates.** Where the data is contested the notes give you the spread and the reason. Quoting a single scary number is the fastest way to lose a numerate CEO.
- **In the deck itself, press N** for this text on screen, **G** for the slide grid, **T** to switch between light and dark.

01 UniverCell, in one briefing

0:00 – 0:45



COVER

OPEN WITH

I spent the last stretch pulling apart a German battery company called UniverCell, and the industry around it. I want to give you the company, but honestly the industry read is worth more to you than the company is.

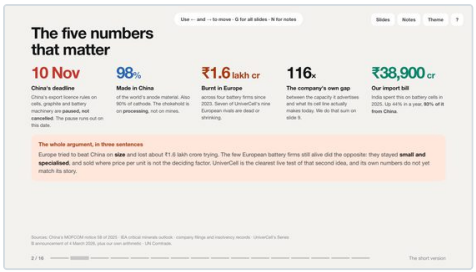
- **Set the frame before the content.** Say plainly: this is intelligence, not a pitch. You are not selling him anything and you have no position in it. That buys you the right to be critical later, and it is what makes slide 9 land.
- **Name the data date.** 20 October 2026. Battery industry facts rot in weeks, and saying so signals you know that.
- **Mention the currency verbally, once.** Every figure is in rupees, converted at ₹95.24 to the dollar and ₹106.82 to the euro, held constant across years so the trends stay comparable. It is not printed on the slide, so say it.
- **Set the clock.** Sixteen slides, about eighteen minutes, and everything deeper is in the PDF. CEOs relax when they know the shape.
- **Do not read the title.** He can read. Use the time to say why you picked this company: it is the clearest live test of the only European battery strategy that has not yet failed.

IF ASKED

"Why this company?" Because it is small enough to understand completely, and because its strategy is the opposite of the one that destroyed ₹1.6 lakh crore in Europe. It is a controlled experiment.

02 The five numbers that matter

0:45 – 3:00



THE SHORT VERSION

OPEN WITH

If you have to leave after one slide, these are the five numbers. The first one has a date on it, which is why it is first.

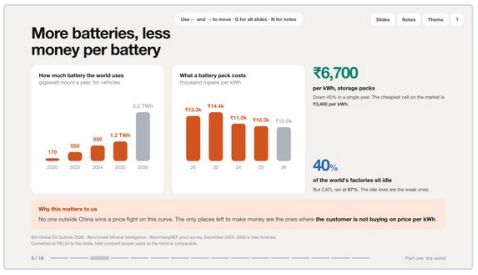
- **Lead with the date and let it sit.** China's export controls on cells above 300 Wh/kg, graphite anode material, and battery production equipment are not cancelled. They are suspended to 10 November 2026. If he pushes: there are reports of an extension into January 2027, but I could not find the numbered instrument, and either way it is a suspension with an expiry date rather than a repeal.
- **Make it his problem, not a geopolitics lecture:** every Indian cell plant being built today runs on Chinese licensed process technology, Chinese machines and Chinese commissioning engineers. All three sit inside that regime.
- **98% anode:** the point is that the chokepoint is processing, not mining. Buying a lithium mine does not fix it.
- **₹1.6 lakh crore:** this is the base rate. Any European battery proposal he sees has to clear it.
- **116x:** flag it now, promise to prove it on slide 9. That creates anticipation and signals you did real work rather than repeating a press release.
- **₹38,900 crore:** his number. India's import bill, up 44% in a year.
- **Then the callout.** Read it almost verbatim. It is the thesis of the whole deck: Europe lost on scale, the survivors won on specialisation, UniverCell is the cleanest live test.

IF ASKED

"Will the Chinese controls actually come back?" Honest answer: nobody knows, and the expiry date itself has reportedly moved once already. The point is not the prediction. It is that the dependency is now a policy variable controlled by someone else, with a date attached.

03 Demand is rising, prices are falling

3:00 – 5:00



PART ONE: THE WORLD

OPEN WITH

Two curves run this industry, and they point in opposite directions. Demand is compounding and price is collapsing, at the same time.

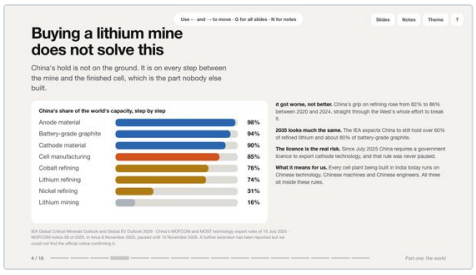
- **Left chart:** EV battery demand went from about 170 GWh in 2020 to 1.2 TWh in 2025. The dashed line is the IEA's 2030 outlook at roughly 3 TWh. Total lithium-ion deployed in 2025, including storage, was 1.59 TWh, up 29%.
- **The quiet shift:** grid storage grew 51% last year against EV's 26%. The growth engine is moving from cars to storage. That matters for India, where the grid-storage pipeline is the fastest-moving segment.
- **Right chart:** the BloombergNEF series. Point at 2022, the only year it ever rose. Everything else is down. ₹10,300 per kWh in 2025.
- **The number that ends arguments:** a stationary-storage pack fell 45% in one year to ₹6,700 per kWh, and the cheapest LFP cell is ₹3,400. Nobody outside China wins a cost fight on this curve.
- **Utilisation is the subtlety worth 30 seconds.** Global utilisation is about 40%, which sounds like there is spare capacity everywhere. But CATL ran at 96.9%. The idle capacity is tier-2 and tier-3. So overcapacity means brutal price pressure in commodity cells while good, qualified capacity stays tight. That gap is exactly what a specialist sells into.

IF ASKED

"If prices keep falling, does localisation ever pay back?" Not on cost alone. It pays back on supply security, tariffs and regulatory access. Say that plainly; do not oversell the economics.

04 China's grip is on processing

5:00 – 6:45



PART ONE: THE WORLD

OPEN WITH

Everyone talks about China and lithium. China's hold is not on the ground. It is on the step between the mine and the cell.

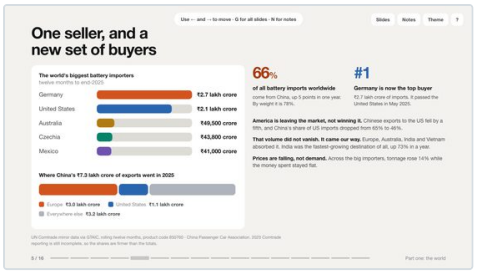
- **Walk the bars top down.** 98% of anode material, 94% of battery-grade graphite, 90% of cathode, 85% of cell capacity. Then the bottom bar: only about 16% of lithium mining. That contrast is the whole slide.
- **Drive it home:** you can buy a mine in Australia or Argentina and still have to ship the output to China to make it useful. Processing is the chokepoint.
- **Concentration rose, it did not fall:** 82% in 2020 to 86% in 2024, right through the entire Western diversification effort. That is the uncomfortable fact.
- **2035 is barely better** on the IEA's own current-policy projection: still over 60% of refined lithium and cobalt, still around 80% of battery-grade graphite.
- **Land on the licence point.** July 2025 put cathode and lithium-processing technology under export licensing, and that one was never suspended. The broader regime is the one that lapses next month.

IF ASKED

"What about recycling as a route around it?" It helps at the margin and India is genuinely good at it, but recycled volumes cannot meet growth demand this decade. Do not let it become the easy answer.

05 Who sells, and who buys

6:45 – 8:30



PART ONE: THE WORLD

OPEN WITH

Now the trade flows, because the buyer list has rearranged in a way most people have not noticed.

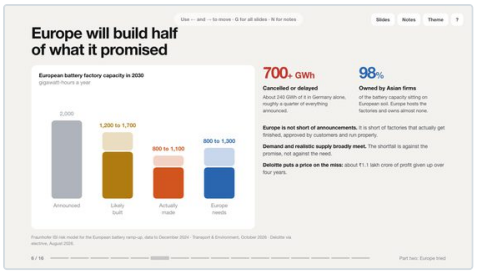
- **Top chart, lead with Germany.** ₹2.7 lakh crore, the largest importer in the world, and it overtook the United States in May 2025. That usually surprises people who assume the US is the big buyer.
- **The US is leaving the market, not winning it.** China's exports to the US fell from ₹1.5 lakh crore to ₹1.1 lakh crore and China's share of US imports fell from 65% to 46%. That is tariffs working as intended.
- **But the volume did not disappear.** It went to Europe, Australia, India and Vietnam. Europe absorbed the diversion: ₹3 lakh crore, 40% of China's exports.
- **India is the fastest-growing destination of all**, up 73% in twelve months on China's own export books. When the US closes a door, the volume lands on him.
- **The structural line:** across the reporting importers, tonnage rose 14% while value stayed flat. Unit prices are collapsing. Cheap cells are being pushed into every market that will take them.
- **Caveat honestly:** 2025 UN Comtrade reporting is incomplete, so trust the shares more than the absolute totals. Saying this protects you if he knows the data.

IF ASKED

"Should India put up tariffs?" Not your call to make in this room. Note that India already charges 10 to 20% basic duty on finished batteries and zero on cell-making equipment, which is a deliberate signal about which end of the chain the government wants built.

06 Europe promised twice what it will build

8:30 – 10:00



PART TWO: EUROPE TRIED

OPEN WITH

Europe's answer to all of this was scale. Here is how that went.

- **Read the chart left to right as a decay.** Over 2 TWh announced for 2030. Fraunhofer's risk model says 1.2 to 1.7 TWh actually gets built, and after delays and yield losses the real output is 0.8 to 1.1 TWh. Against demand of 800 to 1,300 GWh.
- **So the shortage was never announcements.** It was finishing, qualifying and running them.
- **Over 700 GWh delayed or cancelled**, about 240 GWh in Germany alone, roughly a quarter of everything announced since 2022.
- **The most damning number on the slide:** 98% of Europe's own 2025 cell production capacity is controlled by Asian manufacturers. Europe built factories on its soil and does not own them.
- **Deloitte's price tag:** ₹1.1 lakh crore of forgone profit over four years, and lost value added that could reach ₹10.7 to 16 lakh crore by 2030.
- **Pivot line into the next slide:** that is the aggregate. The next slide is the body count.

IF ASKED

"Is this just a European failure, or structural?" Mostly structural: they competed on cost against an incumbent with a decade of learning-curve advantage. The survivors are the ones who did not.

07 Seven of its nine rivals are gone

10:00 – 12:00



PART TWO: EUROPE TRIED

OPEN WITH

This is the slide I would want to see if I were writing the cheque. Seven of this company's nine European peers are dead, shrunken or cancelled, and all of it happened in about eighteen months.

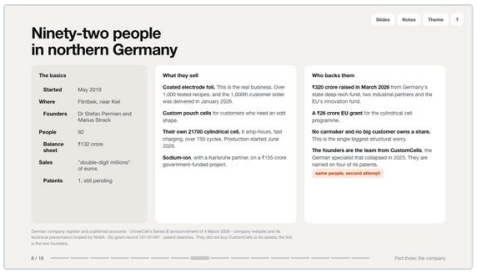
- **Do not read the table.** Let him read it. Pick three: Northvolt raised about ₹1.4 lakh crore and shipped one gigawatt-hour against a sixteen gigawatt-hour target. Varta failed twice, two years apart. CustomCells was killed by one customer not paying.
- **Then the callout, slowly.** Morrow's 1 GWh plant was, per the reporting, far too small to supply a major car manufacturer. UniverCell's target is 1.3 GWh. The same sentence applies to it.
- **And immediately give the defence,** because it is a real one: UniverCell is not trying to supply a car manufacturer. In power tools, drones, medical and space, 1 GWh is a large share of demand, not a rounding error. That is a genuinely different business model, not a smaller version of Northvolt.
- **The survival logic is the transferable lesson.** Every European survivor is owned by a carmaker. Every independent merchant cell startup that tried the open market has failed.
- **Be straight about the scorecard:** UniverCell passes two of the three tests and fails the first. It has no OEM anchor. Say that out loud; it is the most important sentence on the slide.
- **Note the ACC line if he is engaged:** Europe's flagship carmaker-owned cell venture cancelled two European gigafactories and replaced them with a Chinese joint venture in Spain. That is the whole European story in one decision.

IF ASKED

"So why would anyone back this sector?" Because the failures were failures of scale and market choice, not of geography. That distinction is the entire investment case, and it is still unproven.

08 What UniverCell actually is

12:00 – 13:30



PART THREE: THE COMPANY

OPEN WITH

So here is the company itself. Ninety-two people in Schleswig-Holstein. I will give you what is verifiable and flag what is not.

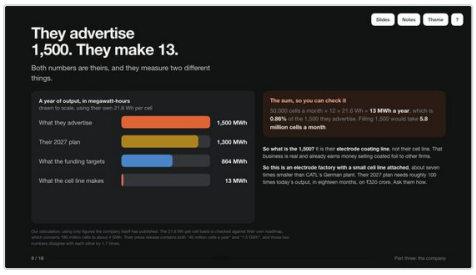
- **Correct the record early, it builds credibility:** most sources say founded in Kiel or Flintbek in 2019. The register says registered in Elmshorn in May 2019 and moved to Flintbek in November 2020.
- **The business is three things,** and the order matters: merchant electrode foil, which is the actual revenue; custom pouch cells; and the 21700 cylindrical cell, which started series production in June 2026.
- **The spec is genuinely competitive:** around 330 Wh per kg, 6C, over 750 cycles. That is a real high-performance cell, not a me-too product.
- **The money:** ₹320 crore Series B in March 2026, led by Germany's DeepTech and Climate Fonds with two industrial partners and the EU's Innovation Council. Balance sheet was ₹132 crore at FY2023. Revenue is described only as double-digit millions.
- **Two things to say plainly.** There is no OEM shareholder. And there is exactly one pending patent family, so the moat is process know-how rather than IP.
- **The lineage is the most interesting fact here.** Both founders are named inventors on four patents assigned to Custom Cells Itzehoe, the German custom-cell specialist that collapsed in 2025. This is the successor team, occupying the market that CustomCells vacated. That is simultaneously the bull case and the warning.
- **Be precise:** there is no asset purchase. Do not overclaim it. The link is the people.

IF ASKED

"Who owns it?" Ten shareholders on the register, names behind a paywall. Share capital ₹43 lakh, meaning the ₹320 crore came in almost entirely as share premium.

09 The sum nobody else has done

13:30 – 15:30



PART THREE: THE COMPANY

OPEN WITH

This is the slide that is not in anyone's press release, and it is the reason I would take the meeting with management.

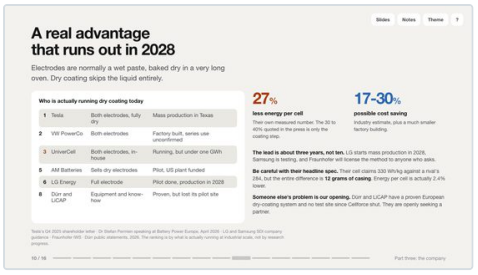
- **Set it up as a puzzle.** The company markets 1.5 GWh. It also says series production began in June 2026 at 50,000 cells a month. Both are in its own material.
- **Do the arithmetic out loud, slowly.** 50,000 times 12 is 600,000 cells. At 21.6 watt-hours each, that is 13 megawatt-hours a year. Against 1.5 gigawatt-hours. That is 0.86%.
- **Pre-empt the obvious objection:** the 21.6 Wh basis is the company's own, validated against its own roadmap, which converts 180 million cells to about 4 GWh, implying 22.2 Wh. You are not using a hostile assumption.
- **Then the clincher.** The same press release says 40 million cells a year. That works out to 0.864 GWh, not 1.5. The company's own two numbers contradict each other by 1.7 times.
- **Which resolves it:** 1.5 GWh cannot be a cell number. It is the cell-equivalent output of the electrode coating line. Cross-check: 60 metres a minute times 0.75 metres times 1,440 minutes equals 64,800 square metres a day, which is exactly the figure they publish.
- **The honest description, and say it kindly:** this is a working electrode plant with a cell pilot attached. That is not a criticism, it is just not a gigafactory. The electrode business is real and already earning revenue.
- **The question that follows:** 2027 needs roughly 100 times the current run-rate in eighteen months, funded by ₹320 crore. Ask them how.
- **One correction to carry:** do not repeat the 64,000 square metre facility figure. It is a daily output number misread as floor area. The founder himself puts the footprint at about 6,100 square metres.

IF ASKED

"Are you saying they are being dishonest?" No. Say no clearly. The numbers measure different things and the company never explicitly claimed 1.5 GWh of cells. But the market reads it that way, and you should not.

10 The one real advantage

15:30 – 17:00



PART THREE: THE COMPANY

OPEN WITH

So if the scale is small, what is actually worth something here? One thing: the process.

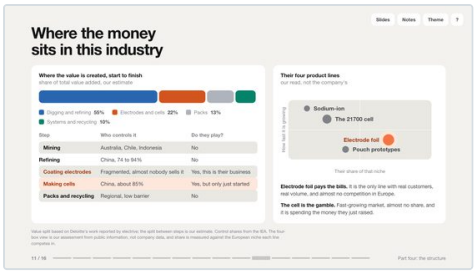
- **Explain dry coating in one sentence:** conventional electrodes are made as a wet slurry that then has to be dried in an oven the length of a cricket pitch. Dry coating skips the solvent entirely.
- **Why it matters commercially:** less energy, a materially smaller factory, and better electrode structure. Industry estimates put the cell cost reduction at 17 to 30%.
- **Use the right number.** UniverCell's own measured figure is 27% less energy at cell level. The 30 to 40% in the press is the process step, not the finished cell. If he checks, you are right and the press is loose.
- **The ranking is the payoff.** On operating industrial dry coating, Tesla is first, VW PowerCo second, and UniverCell is credibly third in the world. Pause there. Then undercut it honestly: it is third by about a factor of a thousand on scale.
- **The expiry date is the strategic point.** LG reaches mass production in 2028, Samsung SDI is piloting, and Fraunhofer licenses the platform to anyone who asks. The lead is roughly three years deep, not ten.
- **Puncture the spec claim before he does.** 330 Wh per kg sounds decisive against Molicel's 284. At an identical 6.0 amp-hours, the entire gap is 12 grams of housing, and energy per cell is actually 2.4% lower. It is a packaging win, not a chemistry win. Saying this yourself is worth more than the claim was.
- **Flag the caveat yourself before anyone else does:** the published 750 millimetre, 60 metre a minute line with an 80 metre twelve-zone dryer has to be the wet line. Dry coating has no solvent to evaporate and needs no dryer. The dry line's actual throughput is not published anywhere.
- **Then the opening, and this is the one to remember.** Dürr and LiCAP have a validated European dry-coating platform and lost their pilot host when Cellforce closed. They are publicly looking for a partner. That is an available European dry-electrode capability with no home.

IF ASKED

"Could we just license dry coating from Tesla?" No. Tesla does not sell cells or licence process technology. The realistic Western routes are Dürr and LiCAP, Fraunhofer, or a partnership with someone operating a line.

11 Where the money sits

17:00 – 18:15



PART FOUR: THE STRUCTURE

OPEN WITH

Two frameworks on one slide, because they answer the same question: is the company standing where the money is?

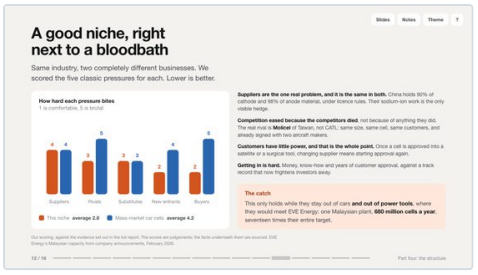
- **The chain bar first.** Roughly 55% of value added sits in materials and refining, which China holds. About 22% in electrode and cell. The rest in pack and system.
- **So the honest answer is no,** UniverCell is not in the fattest part of the chain. Nobody in Europe is. But it is in the part Europe can actually contest.
- **The non-obvious point in the table:** electrode coating is the one stage with almost no merchant supply anywhere in Europe. Everyone else coats for themselves. UniverCell sells it. That is a genuine niche, and it is where its revenue is.
- **On the BCG, label it honestly as your assessment,** not company data, and say relative share is a qualitative band because its absolute share of every market rounds to zero.
- **Electrode foil is the cash cow**, the only line with customers, volume and defensibility. The 21700 is the question mark: high growth, no share, and it is eating the Series B. Sodium-ion is an option, not a business, and it is publicly funded.
- **The strategic read:** a company whose cash cow is its least glamorous product, funding a question mark that gets all the press. That is a normal and risky position, and worth naming.

IF ASKED

"Should they just stick to electrodes?" Arguably yes on today's numbers. The counter is that electrodes alone cap them as a component supplier with no pricing power. The cell is the bid for a defensible end-market position.

12 Why the niche works

18:15 – 19:45



PART FOUR: THE STRUCTURE

OPEN WITH

Porter, but with one twist that makes it worth the time: I scored the same five forces twice, for two different markets.

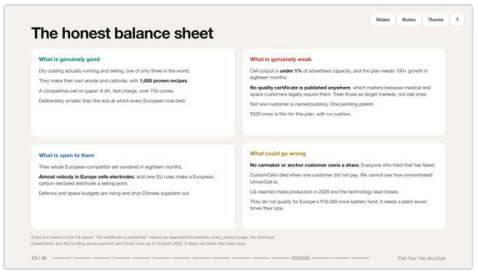
- **Define the segment first,** out loud. European custom and specialty cells and merchant electrodes for qualification-locked applications. Explicitly not commodity EV cells.
- **The orange bars are the niche, the blue are the commodity market.** The shape difference is the insight: 2.8 average against 4.2. Same industry, completely different economics.
- **Supplier power is the one brutal force in both, at 4,** and it is the one UniverCell cannot fix. 90% of cathode, 98% of anode, under a licensing regime. The sodium-ion work with Litona is the only visible hedge.
- **Rivalry collapsed to 3 by attrition,** not by strategy. Seven peers exited in eighteen months. Be honest that this is survivorship.
- **The sharpest line on the slide:** the real competitor is not CATL, it is Molicel. Same size, same high-drain 21700, same eVTOL and drone customers, already signed to Archer and Vertical Aerospace. Any deck that benchmarks this company against CATL is flattering and useless.
- **Buyers are weak precisely because qualification locks them in.** Once a cell is designed into a satellite or a surgical tool, switching means requalifying. That is the economic moat in this niche, and it is also why revenue takes years to arrive.
- **End on the verdict.** Attractive only while it stays out of automotive and out of power tools. EVE Energy's Malaysian plant alone makes 680 million 21700 cells a year, seventeen times UniverCell's entire target. Power tools are on its website. That is its weakest strategic claim.

IF ASKED

"Which force would you watch?" Supplier power. If the November controls return and bite, every non-Chinese cell maker's input costs and lead times move at once, and the ones with in-house electrode capability suffer least.

13 Strengths and weaknesses

19:45 – 21:00



PART FOUR: THE STRUCTURE

OPEN WITH

The balance sheet on the company. I have tried to make the right-hand column hurt as much as the left-hand column flatters.

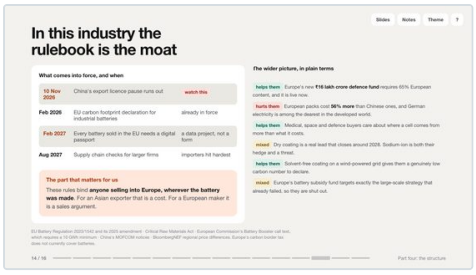
- **Do not read all twenty items.** Take one from each quadrant and let him scan.
- **Strength:** operating industrial dry coating with 1,000-plus qualified recipes. Recipes are the asset nobody can copy quickly, because each one is a customer relationship and a year of work.
- **Weakness, and this is the one to say slowly:** no certification is publicly evidenced. Not ISO 9001, not ISO 13485 for medical, not AS9100 or ECSS for space, not even UN 38.3 for shipping cells.
- **Be scrupulously fair about it.** You are not saying they lack them. Contract manufacturers often do not publish, and they demonstrably ship cells internationally. You are saying it is not public, and therefore space and medical should be read as target markets rather than qualified supply. It is the first question for management.
- **Opportunity:** the EU Battery Regulation turns an EU-made, carbon-declared electrode into a compliance asset. Regulation is doing work here that no sales team could.
- **Threat:** no OEM anchor, against a track record where every independent European merchant cell startup has failed. And CustomCells died from one customer not paying, which is the precise risk here.
- **The Battery Booster exclusion is worth 15 seconds** because it is counter-intuitive: Europe's ₹16,000 crore battery support programme requires a 10 GWh minimum and a first commercial-scale EV cell plant. UniverCell fails both. The money is aimed at exactly the strategy that already failed.

IF ASKED

"What would change your mind, either way?" Two things. A named anchor customer with contracted volume would upgrade it materially. Evidence that the 2027 ramp is slipping would downgrade it just as fast.

14 The rules are the moat

21:00 – 22:15



PART FOUR: THE STRUCTURE

OPEN WITH

Last structural slide. In this industry the regulation is not overhead, it is the moat, and it is on a published timetable.

- **Work down the dates.** Carbon-footprint declaration for industrial batteries came in this February. Labelling in August. The battery passport in February 2027. Due diligence in August 2027.
- **The asymmetry is the whole point.** These obligations fall on whoever places a battery on the EU market, wherever it was made. For an Asian importer that is a cost and a data problem. For an EU producer that can already declare its footprint, it is a sales argument.
- **Connect it back to the company:** solvent-free coating plus a wind-heavy northern German grid feeds straight into a good carbon-footprint declaration. That is the regulatory logic of the business.
- **The top row is the one with a countdown.** Bring it back to the 10 November date you opened with so the deck closes its own loop.
- **On PESTEL, do not narrate all six.** Point at the tags and name the two that matter: the political tailwind from defence and foreign-entity-of-concern rules, and the economic headwind of a 56% European pack price premium.
- **If he asks about CBAM:** batteries are not currently in scope. Say it and move on. Getting that wrong in front of someone who imports is expensive.

IF ASKED

"Does any of this apply to Indian exporters?" Yes, directly. Anyone selling a battery or a battery-powered product into the EU from February 2027 needs a battery passport. That is a data-infrastructure project, not a form, and it has a deadline.

15 What this is worth to us

22:15 – 24:00



PART FIVE: WHAT WE DO

OPEN WITH

So what is this actually worth to you. Four plays, in order of how cheaply you could test them.

- **Open with his number.** ₹38,900 crore of cell imports in calendar 2025, up 44% by value and 75% by volume, about 93% from China. India is absorbing the price collapse, not escaping the dependence.
- **The PLI tile is the uncomfortable one.** 1.4 GWh commissioned against a 50 GWh target, and nothing disbursed. Say it neutrally, as a fact, not a criticism of policy.
- **Play one is the sharpest and I would spend most of the time here.** Chinese LFP cathode technology now needs Beijing's approval to transfer. European dry-coating process technology does not. Dürr and LiCAP have a validated platform and no pilot host. And the coater itself lands in India at zero basic customs duty until 31 March 2029 under this year's notification. Cheap, fast and time-bound.
- **Play two is the one that fits the evidence best.** Electrode coating is where UniverCell actually makes money, there is almost no merchant electrode supply in Europe, and the same gap exists in India at far larger scale. It is a fraction of the capital of a cell plant and it serves every cell maker rather than competing with them.
- **Play three:** Indian drone, defence, space and power-tool makers have no domestic high-drain cylindrical cell source at all. Small volumes, high margins, qualification lock-in, and sovereign buyers who care about provenance.
- **Play four, with a clear warning.** Distressed European assets are cheap for a reason. The asset worth buying is the team and the recipe library, not the building.
- **Close the slide with the honest caveat:** the FY2030 import bill is ₹1.3 to 2.2 lakh crore depending on whether you believe 115 or 272 GWh of demand and ₹4,800 or ₹8,100 per kWh. Giving the range rather than the scary number is what makes the rest credible.

IF ASKED

"Which one would you do?" Two, then one. Electrodes because the business case stands on its own today, and the process licence because it is cheap, the duty window closes in March 2029 and the Korean competition arrives in 2028.

16 Where this leaves us

24:00 – 25:00



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So where does this leave us. One sentence, then three things we could start on Monday.

- **Read the big statement once, slowly, then stop.** A real electrode business with a genuine process advantage and an unproven cell business, in the one corner of this industry where being small is a strategy rather than a weakness. Do not elaborate on it. It is the whole deck in one line.
- **Then immediately lower the stakes.** We are not being asked to back this company. The value here is the map, not the target. That stops him hearing it as a pitch and makes the next three columns feel like options rather than asks.
- **Left column, the only two things with a real deadline.** Dürr and LiCAP are looking for a partner now, and the duty-free window on cell-making machinery closes in March 2029. The electrode sizing is four weeks of one analyst's time, which is a cheap way to find out if the second play is real.
- **Middle column, the diligence list.** These are written questions, not a meeting. If the certificates and the order book come back thin, we have learned something for the cost of an email.
- **Right column is the one he will remember.** Say plainly what would change your mind in each direction. An analyst who tells a CEO what would prove them wrong is worth more than one who does not.
- **End on the November date.** If China lets the licence pause lapse, every item on this slide moves from interesting to urgent. That is the clock the whole room should leave with.
- **Then stop talking.** The close is the discussion, not another slide.

IF ASKED

"What do you actually recommend?" Two phone calls and four weeks of one analyst. Nothing on this slide commits capital, and all of it buys information we do not currently have.